वेदशास्त्राणि - कल्पशास्त्रम् (*Vēda Śāstras - Kalpa-śāstra)*

Abstract
This discussion elucidates the interrelation between the *Vēda*, its exegetical methods, and the corresponding *Vēdic mantras* that substantiate each methodological principle. The *Vēda*, transcending the six *Śāstras*, is revealed as *Śabda-Brahman*, the Eternal Sound or Absolute Word, serving as the ontological foundation of knowledge and ritual action. Since human cognition arises through the five gross elements (*pañca-bhūtas*), comprehension initially manifests as *laukika-jñāna* (worldly cognition), which subsequently evolves toward transcendental realization. Classical authorities such as Yāska Āchārya illustrate the esoteric interpretation of *Vēdic* terms, demonstrating that *Vēdic* semantics operate beyond conventional linguistic constraints.
The discussion further examines how *Vēdāksharas* and mantras function operatively within the ritual framework, prescribing specific sacrificial acts (*karma*) and their precise temporal performance. The *Kalpa-śāstra* literature, expressed in the succinct *Sūtra* style, encapsulates profound metaphysical meaning within condensed linguistic formulations. The recurrence of the term *Kalpa* in the *Vēda* underscores its sacred function as both ritual and cosmic order.
At its core, the *Vēda* identifies *Yajña* as the transformative principle of existence, the sacred process by which the finite returns to the infinite. The act of kindling *Agni* wherever cognition and consciousness arise symbolizes the ignition of divine awareness within the human and cosmic domains alike. This perpetual interaction between the subtle (*sūkṣma*) and the cosmic (*brahmāṇḍa*) realms constitutes the essence of *Yajña*. Ultimately, the *Vēda* reveals that the inherent law of creation (*sṛṣṭi-lakṣaṇa*) lies in the continual return of all manifestations to their primordial source.

Keywords: Yajña**,** imagination*, Paśu, Bhārati, food offerings.*

Introduction:
After the revelation of the *Vēda*, the *Ṛṣis* (seers), in their pursuit of understanding its meaning (*Vēdārtha*), developed six auxiliary disciplines (*Vēdāṅgas*) through systematic and philosophical inquiry. These six may be divided into two main categories.
The first three primarily concern the *phonetic* and *structural* dimensions of the *Vēdākshara*: its form, pronunciation, and the method by which Vēdāksharas are arranged within the *Ṛks* (hymns). These are:

- *Vyākaraṇa* (Grammar)
- *Śikṣā* (Phonetics or Instruction in Pronunciation)
- *Chandas* (Metre)

The remaining three pertain to the *semantic* and *interpretative* aspects of the *Vēdākshara* and of the words formed from it. These are:

- *Nirukta* (Etymology or Exegesis)
- *Jyotiṣa* (Astronomy and Calculations of Time)
- *Kalpa* (Ritual Practice and Procedure)

Thus, while the first triad focuses on the *sound-body* of the Vēda, the latter triad elucidates its *meaning-body*, together constituting the comprehensive science of Vēdic expression and interpretation.
Since the *Śāstras* were formulated by human effort after the revelation of the *Vēda*, they cannot themselves be considered *Vēda*, nor can they be regarded as equivalent to it. The *Śāstras* merely serve as methodological pathways for comprehending the Vēdic word (*Vēda-śabda*). The *Vēda* transcends these six *Śāstras* and is the manifestation of *Śabda-Brahman*, the Eternal Word or Sound Absolute.
The disciplines of *Nirukta*, *Jyotiṣa*, and *Kalpa* concern knowledge of the external, phenomenal world, whereas the *Vēda* reveals the inner worlds (*antar-lokas*) of human consciousness. The Vēdic statement "त्रया इमे लोकाः (*Traya ime lokāḥ)*" ("These are the three worlds") refers not to the ordinary or material sense of the term *loka* (world), but to its deeper, Vēdic meaning: the states or dimensions of inner realization.
The meanings of Vēdic words (*Vēda-śabdas*) are not objects of mere conceptual inference (*ūha*); they are to be *illumined* or *directly intuited* (*sphuraṇa*). Since human beings are composed of the five gross elements (*pañca-bhūtas*), their comprehension of meaning initially arises through worldly cognition

(लौकिक ज्ञान - *laukika-jñāna*). However, the Vēdāksharas, words (*padas*), and sentences (*vākyas*) of the *Vēda* are divinely bestowed in such a way that they naturally awaken and communicate meaning to the human consciousness, bridging the finite and the transcendental.

In the human world, the meanings of words in various languages can be discerned through dictionaries, and knowledge can be acquired through the instruction of teachers and formal education. However, such a method is **not applicable in the study of the Vēda**. For understanding the Vēda, one must employ the **six auxiliary disciplines (Vēdāṅgas)** together with **Mīmāṃsā treatises**, which serve as interpretative aids.

Vēdic words must not be interpreted according to their **ordinary worldly meanings**. Attempts to do so have led many **Western scholars and intellectuals** to misinterpret the Vēda, treating it as a work composed by humans and as a product of ordinary intellectual tradition.

For instance, the renowned Vēdic scholar **Yāska Āchārya** derived the meaning of the Vēdic term *Bhārati* as "the Sun," an interpretation that stands apart from the conventional meaning in Sanskrit usage, where no such relation exists between *Bhārati* and *Sūrya*. Similarly, **Sāyaṇa Āchārya**, at the very beginning of his commentary on the RigVēda, expounded **five distinct meanings for the word "Agni"**, thus demonstrating the deeper semantic and philosophical layers of Vēdic language.

The meanings of **Vēdic words cannot be confined or limited**. Among the various efforts to interpret the Vēdāksharas, speech forms (*vāk*), and sounds (*śabdas*) found in the Vēdas, the perspective of the **Vēdic auxiliary sciences (Vēdāṅgas)** is of great significance. Yet, among them, the **Kalpa-śāstra** holds the **highest level of importance**.

While the remaining disciplines aim primarily at explaining the meanings of Vēdic words, **Kalpa** not only establishes and demonstrates meaning but also reveals the **hidden principles and procedural paths** underlying ritual and practice. It presents **Vēdāksharas and mantras in their functional or operative aspect**, meaning it prescribes the ritual acts corresponding to specific mantras and mandates their **recitation at the proper ritual moments**.

Thus, the Kalpa texts serve to render the meaning of the Vēda **intelligible and contextually relevant** during ritual performance. The **Kalpa-śāstra literature**, being primarily composed in the **Sūtra style**, is characterized by concise statements formed from minimal Vēdāksharas, yet embodying **extensive and profound semantic implications** expressed through **brief, technical phrases**.

For the **RigVēda**, the principal *Śrauta Sūtras* were composed by **Āśvalāyana** and **Śāṅkhāyana**.

For the **Kṛṣṇa Yajur Vēda**, the *Śrauta Sūtras* were authored by **Baudhāyana**, **Āpastamba**, and **Bhāradvāja**.

For the **Śukla Yajur Vēda**, they were composed by **Kātyāyana**, **Lāṭyāyana**, **Drāhyāyaṇa**, and **Jaimini**.

For the **Sāma Vēda**, the *Śrauta Sūtras* were again formulated by **Lāṭyāyana**, **Drāhyāyaṇa**, and **Jaimini**.

For the **Atharva Vēda**, the *Śrauta Sūtras* were compiled by **Kauśika**, **Āṅgīrasa**, and others.

In later periods, a considerable number of **commentaries (vyākhyānas)** were composed on these *Śrauta Sūtras*. Some of these were **incomplete**, while others gave rise to **further layers of sub-commentaries**, expanding upon or clarifying earlier interpretations.

For example, the revered scholar **Dhūrta Svāmi** composed a commentary on the *Āpastamba Śrauta Sūtra* of the Kṛṣṇa Yajur Vēda. Subsequently, the eminent **Rāmāgni Chit** authored a detailed **Vṛtti** (sub-commentary) on Dhūrta Svāmi's exposition. The sections that Dhūrta Svāmi had left unfinished were later supplemented by **Kapardi Svāmi**, who completed the commentary tradition associated with this text.

Scholarly Commentarial Tradition and the Concept of "Kalpa" in the Vēdic Corpus

Renowned Vēdic scholars and philosophers such as **Bhāskara Somayāji**, **Rudradatta**, and **Keśava Svāmi** also composed extensive commentaries elucidating the Vēdic and Śrauta traditions. Among the classical exegetical works, the commentary written by **Śabara Svāmi** on **Jaimini's Pūrva Mīmāṃsā Sūtras** stands as one of the most authoritative and widely acknowledged treatises in the field of Vēdic hermeneutics.

The term **"Kalpa"** is frequently encountered within the **Vēdic Saṃhitās** as a sacred expression. It appears in several passages, notably in the **Taittirīya Saṃhitā** (1.7.9; 4.7.10) and in the **Vājasaneyi Saṃhitā** (18.19), where it forms an integral part of the *Vājapeya Yāga Mantra*. It also manifests in the

Sāma Vēda as the *Vasoddhāra Mantra*, further demonstrating its ritual and symbolic significance across the Vēdic canon.
The **Vēda**, in its essential spirit, is primarily concerned with the **Yajña**, the sacred act of transformation through sacrificial fire. It repeatedly affirms that *Yajña* represents the human endeavor and divine action that elevates existence from a lower to a higher state of being. Wherever thoughts arise, where knowledge conducive to the conduct of living beings is found, and where the primal wisdom underlying human birth is manifested, **there, the sacred fire (Agni)** must be kindled. It is through this inner and outer awakening that the **determinate perceptions of the inner consciousness (antar-jagat)** are directed towards the locus of divine realization.

The Concept of "Saṃjñānam" and the Metaphysical Significance of Yajña
The Veda designates that divine state as *Sanjñānam* (the state of higher consciousness). The effort to attain or unite with this *Sanjñānam* is termed *Yajña* (sacrificial endeavor). These are the names conferred by the Veda itself. Furthermore, the Veda characterizes this sacred effort as *Deva-karma*, the divine act. *"Śundhadhvam daivyai karmaṇe Dēvā yājyāyai"* as stated in the *Taittirīya Saṃhitā* (1.1.3): meaning "Be purified for the divine act, for the Yajña pertaining to the gods."
Since the *Yajña* pertains to the *Dēvatās* (divine powers), it necessarily involves their participation and presence. The process of Yajña, therefore, is the manifestation of divine energies (*Dēva Śakti*) within the ritual act itself.
In living beings, imagination (*ūha*) is an eternal and spontaneous faculty. These cognitive impulses arise of their own accord; humans do not create them. However, the source of this generative power within us remains unknown, its moral, ethical, and ontological nature eludes ordinary perception. The entity that illumines and regulates this unseen energy is **Brahman**, the indwelling and all-pervading consciousness (*sarvāntaryāmin*). Although Brahman resides within beings, its light often remains unmanifest to them.
The Vēda describes the force that cultivates noble impulses and sustains the priestly function of guidance as **"रक्षस्सु - Rakṣassu"**, the protective power that nurtures higher consciousness. Conversely, the force that generates opposition to the Brahmanic principle is termed **"राक्षस - Rākṣasa"**, the demonic or obstructive energy. The upward-turning, aspirational tendencies within beings are identified as **"Dēvatā Śaktis"**, divine forces that elevate existence. Both categories of energies, divine and demonic, operate universally within all beings and throughout creation, serving as the fundamental causes of all actions.
Through **Yajñas** and **Yāgas**, one must transcend the influence of the *Rākṣasa bhāvas* and their disruptive tendencies. Failure to do so results inevitably in separation from the **Brahman-consciousness**. The **Kalpa Śāstras**, the ritual sciences, serve as guides illuminating the pathways to such transcendence.
The word **"Kalpa"**, a recurrent term in the Vēdic lexicon, is itself a *Vēdic Śabda* signifying sacred procedure and divine order. As stated earlier, the *Taittirīya Saṃhitā*, particularly in the *Vājapeya Mantra*, expounds the concept of *Kalpa* in a clear and comprehensive manner, emphasizing its role as both a ritual and metaphysical framework for realizing the divine order inherent in the cosmos.
Vēdic Citation
Taittirīya Saṁhitā 1.7.9; 4.7.10; Vāja Saṁhitā 18.19
"Āyur yajñena kalpatām,
Prāṇo yajñena kalpatām,
Apāno yajñena kalpatām,
Vyāno yajñena kalpatām,
Cakṣur yajñena kalpatām,
Śrotraṁ yajñena kalpatām,
Mano yajñena kalpatām,
Vāk yajñena kalpatām,
Ātmā yajñena kalpatām,
Yaṅgano yajñena kalpatām."

The Metaphysical Structure of Yajña and the Concept of Kalpa
According to the Vēdic revelation, all living beings, whether engaged in ordinary activity (*sāmānya karma*) or in divinely inspired Yajña (*Dēva-bhāva-yukta yajña*), act only through the coordinated functioning of

“आयुः - **āyuḥ” (vital duration), prāṇa (life-force), apāna (downward breath), and vyāna (diffusive energy)**. The Vēdic mantras declare this truth, and human experience corroborates it.
However, the deeper teaching is not merely that these vital forces sustain life, but that life itself must be **guided along the path of Yajña**. The first act of creation itself is described as **“the birth of imagination (ūha)”**, which is the **primordial Yajña (prathama yajña)**. Every subsequent act arises only after this initial emergence of thought.
Yajña thus signifies *the unification of mind and knowledge in order to realize what is sought*. Within this process, three principles coalesce, **effort (prayatna), mind (manas), and knowledge (jñāna)**. He who performs this sacred act is termed **Prajāpati**.
“Yajñaḥ Prajāpatiḥ” (*Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa* 3.8.23)
“Prajāpatyo yajñaḥ” (*Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa* 3.7.1)
In Vēdic terminology, the word **“prajā”** refers to *imaginative impulses* or *mental progeny*. Their locus of generation lies in the union of mind and knowledge. The power that brings forth these imaginative movements is **Prajāpati**, and the Vēda designates the domain of their origin as **“Samudra”**, the cosmic ocean of consciousness.
Prajāpati not only generates the *ūhas* but also integrates them into the flow of life, nurturing them as natural tendencies within beings. Hence the Brāhmaṇa text states: **“Prajāpatyo yajñaḥ”**, the act of creation itself is the act of Yajña.
Since the *ūhas* are infinite and ceaselessly arising, they must ultimately merge back into their source, the **primordial knowledge (mūla-jñāna)** from which they arose. This cyclical return is the very **law of creation (sṛṣṭi-lakṣaṇa)**, all that is born must return to its origin. This process occurs eternally in both the *microcosm* and *macrocosm*, constituting an ongoing **cosmic yajña**.
In the *Taittirīya Saṃhitā*, particularly within the *Vājapeya Mantras*, the key Vēdic expressions “Yajña” and “Kalpa” are revealed. Understanding these terms is essential to discerning the mantra’s meaning; mere lexical knowledge is insufficient. The meaning of Vēdic words must be discerned through **akṣara-dṛṣṭi**, the contemplative vision of the phoneme.
The Vēdākshara **“क - ka”**, the first of the consonantal (*sparśa*) Vēdāksharas, signifies **action (kriyā)**.
Thus, in “कः प्रजापती”, **क** marks the active principle, while *“र”* represents the *jīva* or living consciousness.
In the term **“Kalpa”**, the Vēdāksharas hold symbolic meanings:

- **क** - denotes action,
- ***ल*** - represents the soul in the state of divine awareness,
- ***प*** - refers to the threefold embodiment (gross, subtle, causal),
- ***म*** - signifies the mind,
- ***उ*** - implies *purohitam*, the act of inner consecration.

Hence, **Kalpa** means *“the movement of the mind directing the three bodies toward divine consciousness (Brahma-bhāva)”*. In essence, **Kalpa is the divine orientation of life through the will to perform Yajña**.
The Vēda employs the fifth consonants of each varga (क, च, ट, त, प) to denote **epistemic or jñāna-related concepts**, showing that every emerging *ūha* (imaginative impulse) depends on the innate knowledge born with the soul.
Thus:

- The **arising of imagination** is *Yajña*,
- The **generative power** is *Prajāpati*,
- The **divine orientation** of that movement is *“कल्प”*.

A further profound term is **“Paśu”**. Not all imaginations return to their source. When they are transformed by mind and knowledge into *desires (kāma)*, the Vēda names them *Paśu*. Every living being performs Yajña naturally to attain its *Paśu*, the fulfillment of desire.
In this pursuit, the vital and cognitive faculties - **āyuḥ, prāṇa, apāna, vyāna, cakṣus, śrotra, manas, vāk, and ātmā** are employed. When these are used for worldly purposes, the result is mere *karma*; when they are infused with **divine intent (Dēva-bhāva)**, the same acts become **Yajña**.
The word **“Paśu”** itself encodes profound meaning:

- प - the three bodies,
- श - peace, bliss, and auspiciousness,
- उ - the life-breath.

Thus, *Paśu* signifies *a desire that brings peace and fulfillment to the physical, mental, and intellectual bodies*. When desire ascends toward the divine, it becomes a vehicle of joy. Hence, through **Dēva-bhāva Karmas**, even the *Paśu-like* tendencies of ordinary life can lead beings toward higher realization.
A **divine Yajña** thus transforms *Paśu* into *Brahma-bhāva*; the attainment of *Paśu* symbolizes the attainment of Brahman. All *Paśus*, in the metaphysical sense are *Yajña-related entities*, and their true destination is **Saṃjñānam**, the field of divine cognition. As more *Paśus* (rightly directed desires) converge in this Saṃjñānam, it becomes increasingly potent, giving rise to higher-order imaginations (*ūhas*).
As the *Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa* (3.9.6) declares:
"Prajā vai paśavo garbhaḥ; prajāmeva paśūn ātmā dhatte", "The living beings are the offspring of imagination; the Self itself bears the Paśus within as luminous potential."
In Vēdic usage, *garbha* denotes *the luminous path of realization*. Therefore, to guide the *Paśus* along the Brahmanic path for the sake of *noble progeny (uttama prajā)* is the essence of **Kalpa**.
"Yajamānaḥ Paśuḥ" - (*Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa* 2.2.8)
Here, *Yajamāna* denotes the state of one performing Yajña, wherein the mind and the self, filled with divine intent, themselves become *Paśu-like*, that is, vehicles of transformation.
The **desires shaped by Brahmanic awareness** become the *Yajamāna*. Through continual Yajña, one ascends gradually toward higher states of being. Since *ūhas* constitute the very nature of beings, the transformation of this nature requires **Vēdic Mantra-guided Yajña**.
The result of such *Yajña* is the **elevation of life and breath (āyuḥ, prāṇa)** through **Kalpa**, the principle that harmonizes and strengthens the inner instruments (*indriyas*).
Kalpa, being the enactment of *Agni-kārya*, is therefore a **Vāk-Yajña**, a Yajña of speech. The *Vāk-Yajña* involves mantric utterance formed from Vēdic phonemes that awaken the inner energies of cognition. Through *Svādhyāya* and *Pravacana*, it unites imagination, emotion, and knowledge, empowering speech to transform latent desires (*Paśus*) into luminous realization.
Just as **Ākāśa** expanded into space, **Vāyu** into motion, and **Pṛthvī** into solidity at the dawn of creation, so too did **Śabda-Brahman**, the Vēdic Word, unfold into manifestation.
The *Kalpa Śāstras* elucidate how divine cognition arises through *Vāk-Yajña*, the sacred transformation whereby the energies of speech generate divine awareness. The essence of the phrase **"Yajñena Kalpatām"** thus signifies: *May one be harmonized, strengthened, and divinized through Yajña.*
The *Kalpa* strengthens the vital and cognitive organs- **āyuḥ, prāṇa, apāna, vyāna, cakṣus, śrotra, and indriyas**, by aligning them with the divine will. The term *Indriya* (composed of *न, द, र, य*) itself implies *the faculties that, through Yajña, attain divine orientation and return to the seat of knowledge*.
Therefore, every mantra's invocation of *Indriya* expresses the aspiration:
"May we, through Yajña, attain divine awareness."
"Ātmā Yajñena Kalpatām" - "May the Self be perfected through Yajña."
In the Vēdic idiom, such expressions differ fundamentally from their conventional Sanskrit meanings. When the Vēda declares:
"Yajno yajñena kalpatām"
It reveals that through the **Yajña of speech (Vāk-Yajña)**, all subsequent inner Yajñas those of life, mind, and sense become suffused with Brahman-consciousness. Through mantra recitation and contemplation, the *indriyas* are invigorated, the three bodies harmonized, and the being oriented toward divine awareness.
This orientation **Dēva-bhāvana-abhimukha sthiti** is the sacred state in which arise the luminous *ūhas* (imaginative intuitions) and *paśus* (desires) that, under the light of *Kalpa*, lead to the realization of cosmic truth.
Thus, **to unite the literal (akṣara) and the metaphysical meaning of the Vēdic word is itself Tapas and Kalpa** the supreme discipline of knowledge and realization.

Discussion:

In this section we will state the important points in the Introduction, the corresponding Methods, and the Veda Mantras that are related to them.
The *Vēda* transcends these six *Śāstras* and is the manifestation of *Śabda-Brahman*, the Eternal Word or Sound Absolute [Method-1, Ref (1)].
Since human beings are composed of the five gross elements (*pañca-bhūtas*), their comprehension of meaning initially arises through worldly cognition (लौकिक ज्ञान - *laukika-jñāna*) [Method-2, Ref (2)].
For instance, the renowned Vēdic scholar **Yāska Āchārya** derived the meaning of the Vēdic term *Bhārati* as "the Sun," an interpretation that stands apart from the conventional meaning in Sanskrit usage, where no such relation exists between *Bhārati* and *Sūrya.* [Method-3a, Ref (3)].
It presents **Vēdāksharas and mantras in their functional or operative aspect**, meaning it prescribes the ritual acts corresponding to specific mantras and mandates their **recitation at the proper ritual moments**. [Method-4, Ref (4)]
The **Kalpa-śāstra literature**, being primarily composed in the **Sūtra style**, is characterized by concise statements formed from minimal Vēdāksharas, yet embodying **extensive and profound semantic implications** expressed through **brief, technical phrases**. [Method-5, Ref (5)]
The term **"Kalpa"** is frequently encountered within the **Vēdic Saṃhitās** as a sacred expression. [Method-6, Ref (6)]
The **Vēda**, in its essential spirit, is primarily concerned with the **Yajña**, the sacred act of transformation through sacrificial fire. [Method-7, Ref (7)]
Wherever thoughts arise, where knowledge conducive to the conduct of living beings is found, and where the primal wisdom underlying human birth is manifested, **there, the sacred fire (Agni)** must be kindled. [Method-8, Ref (8)]
The Veda designates that divine state as *Sanjñānam* (the state of higher consciousness). The effort to attain or unite with this *Sanjñānam* is termed *Yajña* (sacrificial endeavor). These are the names conferred by the Veda itself. Furthermore, the Veda characterizes this sacred effort as *Deva-karma*, the divine act. [Method-9, Ref (9)].
This activity perpetually takes place within both the subtle (*sūkṣma*) and the cosmic (*brahmāṇḍa*) spheres; therefore, it too is a form of *Yajña* (sacrificial process).
Through this mantra, it is demonstrated that returning to the source from which all things have originated is the inherent principle of creation (*sṛṣṭi-lakṣaṇa*) [Method-10, Ref (10)]

Methods:

Method-1:

RigVēda (1-10-4)

- **देवता:** इन्द्रः
- **ऋषि:** मधुच्छन्दाः वैश्वामित्रः
- **छन्द:** भुरिगुष्णिक्
- **स्वर:** ऋषभः

एहि॒ स्तोमाँ॑ अ॒भिस्व॑रा॒भि गृ॑णी॒हया॑ रुव। ब्रह्म॑ च नो वसो॒ सचेन्द्र॑ य॒ज्ञं च॑ वर्धय॥

Essence of RigVēda (1-10-4):

O Supreme Being, who dwells within all things! From every direction, approach us and manifest Thyself. From all sides, may the tones of the *udātta* and other accents, along with the collective meanings of the hymns, radiate the brilliance of *śabda-vidyā*, the sacred science of sound. O Indra, bestower of divine knowledge! Illuminate before us the true meaning of the *Vēda* and cause our *yajña* to flourish and expand.

Proposition

- **Question:** What is meant by “all directions”?
  Answer: The six directions, which correspond to the six *śāstras* (branches of sacred knowledge).
- **Question:** What does the term “this world” signify?
  Answer: It signifies the *Jyotiṣa Kalpa*, the cosmic order of luminous cycles and time.
- **Question:** Who offers praises through the modulations of sound (*svaras*)?
  Answer: The Supreme Being who bestows the divine sound of the *Vēda*.
- **Question:** To whom is the meaning of the *Vēda* revealed?
  Answer: To the living being (*jīva*).
- **Question:** Through the *Vēda* and the *yajña*, what is caused to grow within the individual?
  Answer: The sacred *Vēdic sound* (*Vēda-śabda*) cultivates and expands the knowledge (*jñāna*) of the living being.
- **Question:** How does Indra enhance the cognitive faculties (*jñānendriyas*) of the living being?
  Answer: In the same manner by which he sustains and glorifies the creation of this universe, he also nurtures and elevates the inner worlds of the living being.
- **Question:** Who causes the disciplines of *Śabda-vidyā* (phonetics or *Śikṣā*), *Vēda-artha* (etymology or *Nirukta*), and *Yajña* (ritual practice or *Kalpa*) to prosper and expand?
  Answer: The Supreme Being (*Paramātman*).

Conclusion of Method-1:
The six *śāstras* are contained within the *Vēdas* themselves; therefore, the *Vēda* is supreme among all forms of knowledge.
Just as the Supreme Being (*Paramātman*) fosters and expands this external universe, in the same manner He nurtures and elevates the inner worlds of the individual being (*jīva*) through the performance of *yajña* (sacrificial discipline).
Through this mantra, it is revealed that the *Vēda* transcends the six *śāstras* and embodies the principle of *Śabda Brahman*, the Divine Word or Sound Absolute.
The *Nirukta*, *Jyotiṣa*, and *Kalpa śāstras* pertain to the knowledge of the external, phenomenal world, while simultaneously illuminating the inner realms of human consciousness.

Method-2:
RigVēda (1-102-8)
- **देवता:** इन्द्रः
- **ऋषि:** कुत्स आङ्गिरसः
- **छन्द:** निचृज्जगती
- **स्वर:** निषादः

त्रि॒वि॒ष्टि॒धातु॑ प्रति॒मान॒मोज॑सस्ति॒स्रो भूमी॑र्नृपते॒ त्रीणि॑ रोच॒ना। अती॒दं विश्वं॒ भुव॑नं ववक्षिथाश॒त्रुरि॑न्द्र ज॒नुषा॑ स॒नाद॑सि ॥

Essence of RigVēda (1-102-8):
The dēvat*ā* of this mantra is **Indra**. He governs the universe through **threefold pervasive elements**. Being free from enmity, he naturally illuminates the **three realms of Earth**, each composed of the five fundamental elements, with skill and efficacy. Thus, Indra is always the **causal principle of these three realms**.

Proposition:
- **Question:** What are the faculties or powers of Indra?
  Answer: Action (karman), knowledge (jñāna), and senses (indriyas).
- **Question:** What is the form or measure of Indra?
  Answer: A body composed of the five fundamental elements (pañca-bhautika dēha).
- **Question:** What does Indra naturally illuminate?
  Answer: Speech (vāc).

- **Question:** What are the three elements governing the universe?
  Answer: Potency (sāmarthya), dimension or measure (parimāṇa), and luminosity (prakāśa).
- **Question:** Which entity sustains the Earth composed of these three elements?
  Answer: The sky or firmament (ākāśa).
- **Question:** How is Indra free from enmity?
  Answer: As the eternal cause of the universe through the three elements, he is naturally devoid of enmity.
- **Question:** Who is Indra?
  Answer: A dēvat*ā* and sovereign or ruler (adhipati).
- **Question:** How can bodies compose of the five elements attain meaning or purpose?
  Answer: They must attain it through the three elemental worlds (tridhātu-lokas).

Conclusion of Method-2:
Since human beings are composed of the five elements, they can realize meaning only through the **knowledge of their respective worlds (lokajñāna)**. The Vēdāksharās, words (padas), and sentences (vākya) are **naturally and appropriately ordained** to inspire understanding and significance in living beings. This principle has been **investigated and demonstrated** through the study of the Rigveda mantra (1-102-8).

Method-3a:
RigVēda (10-110-8)
- **देवता:** आप्रियः
- **ऋषि:** जम्दग्नी रामो वा
- **छन्द:** पादनिचृत्त्रिष्टुप्
- **स्वर:** धैवतः

आ नौ॑ य॒ज्ञं भार॑ती॒ तूय॑मे॒त्विळा॑ मनु॒ष्वदि॒ह चे॒तय॑न्ती । ति॒स्रो दे॒वीर्ब॒र्हिरेदं स्यो॒नं सर॑स्वती॒ स्वप॑सः सदन्तु ॥

Essence of RigVēda (10-110-8):
May **Bhāratī**, the radiant power of the **Āditya (solar brilliance)**; **Iḍā**, the terrestrial dēvat*ā* associated with **Agni (the Fire principle)**; and **Sarasvatī**, who perfects and sanctifies **the noblest of actions**, may all these divine powers **bestow their grace and fulfillment**.

Proposition:
- **Question:** Who is the Aprī dēvat*ā*?
  Answer: The Aprī dēvat*ā* is the one through whom human beings obtain **happiness and joy** via the RigVēdic hymns.
- **Question:** Which dēvat*ā* is Bhāratī?
  Answer: Bhāratī is the **radiance within Āditya (the Sun)**. Therefore, the Sun itself is called Bhāratī.
- **Question:** What is the proof for this?
  Answer: The Sun, being the sustainer (**Bharata**) of all beings, nourishes and upholds all living entities with its waters and energy. Hence, the Sun is called Bharata.
- **Question:** What is Iḍā?
  Answer: Iḍā refers to **that which is terrestrial or associated with the Earth**, as explained in the Nighaṇṭu (Vedic lexicon).
- **Question:** Why is Agni called “Iḍā”?
  Answer: Because the **earthly or terrestrial Agni** is referred to as Iḍā.

Conclusion of Method-3a:
Since the Sun sustains all beings with its waters**,** it is thereby demonstrated through this mantra (Rigveda 10-110-8) that Bhāratī refers to the Sun**.**

Method-3b:
RigVēda (1-142-9)

- **देवता:** सरस्वतीळाभारत्यः
- **ऋषि:** दीर्घतमा औचथ्यः
- **छन्द:**निचृदनुष्टुप्
- **स्वर:** गान्धारः

शुचिर्देवेष्वर्पिता होत्रा मरुत्सु भारती। इळा सरस्वती मही बर्हिः सीदन्तु यज्ञियाः ॥

Essence of RigVēda (1-142-9):
The sacred offerings dedicated to the dēvat*ās*, intended to be accepted through the performance of yajña, are received by those fit for yajña among the secondary beings. These include the Sun, lightning, the intermediary principle of speech, the Earth, and the firmament, who remain steadfast across the expanse of space.

Proposition:

- **Question:** How many agents are present in this mantra?
  Answer: Bhāratī, Iḷā, Sarasvatī, and Mahī.
- **Question:** What action are they performing?
  Answer: They are **sīdantu**, that is, they **remain steadfast**.
- **Question:** Upon what are they steadfast?
  Answer: Upon the **Bṛhih (the firmament or space)**.
- **Question:** For what purpose do they remain steadfast?
  Answer: To **perform the yajña** and to **receive the offerings**.
- **Question:** What is Iḷā?
  Answer: Lightning, roaring like an **Urvashi**.
- **Question:** What is Sarasvatī?
  Answer: The **intermediary principle of speech (mādhyamika vāc)**.
- **Question:** What is Bhāratī?
  Answer: The **Sun**.
- **Question:** How is Bhāratī the Sun?
  Answer: Because the **only entity that remains steadfast in space (the firmament) is the Sun**.

Conclusion of Method-3b:
This mantra clearly demonstrates that among those who **remain steadfast in the firmament** and are **engaged in performing the yajña**, **Bhāratī - that is, the Sun - is also one**.

Method-4:
RigVēda (8-30-2)

- **देवता:** विश्वेदेवा:
- **ऋषि:** मनुर्वैवस्वतः
- **छन्द:** पुरउष्णिक्
- **स्वर:** ऋषभः

इति स्तुतासो असथा रिशादसो ये स्थ त्रयश्च त्रिंशच्च । मनोर्देवा यज्ञियासः ॥

Essence of RigVēda (8-30-2):
Those whose mind can harbor friendship with the thirty-three dēvat*ā*s are thus described as being capable of aiding in the destruction of enemies and faults.

Proposition

- **Question:** What is the meaning of the phrase *"presenting letters and mantras in their functional aspect"*?
  Answer: Presenting V**ē**dāksharās and mantras in their functional aspect means assigning the appropriate actions to the mantras and reciting them in accordance with those actions. Simply put, it involves explaining them in an accessible manner. Such Vedic practices and mantras transform the mind toward divinity **and** facilitate the attainment of the grace of the thirty-three dēvat*ā*s**.**
- **Question:** How does *Kalpa* make the Vedic meaning clear at the time of reciting mantras?
  Answer: The Kalpa texts explain the practical application of mantras in a manner that is easily understandable, thereby making the Vedic meaning accessible and well-illustrated for ordinary practitioners**.**

Conclusion of Method-4:
By presenting the V**ē**dāksharās and mantras in their functional aspect that is, by assigning the appropriate actions to the mantras and reciting them at the proper time of action the Kalpa texts make the Vedic meaning intelligible at the time of mantra recitation. This principle is demonstrated through RigVēda (8-30-2).

Method-5:
RigVēda (8-38-1)

- **देवता:** इन्द्राग्नी
- **ऋषि:** श्यावाश्वः
- **छन्द:** गायत्री
- **स्वर:** षड्जः

य॒ज्ञस्य॒ हि स्थ ऋ॒त्विजा॒ सस्नी॒ वाजे॑षु॒ कर्म॑सु । इन्द्रा॑ग्नी॒ तस्य॑ बोधतम् ॥

Essence of RigVēda (8-38-1):
Brahmins and Kṣatriyas are the functionaries in the rites of a yajña. Among them, the Brahmin is the presiding authority. Through the ṛtvij (Vedic officiant)**,** he ascertains with certainty the purity of knowledge and consciousness of the individual performing the rites.

Proposition:

- **Question:** Who are the functionaries in the actions of a yajña?
  Answer: Brahmins and Kṣatriyas are the functionaries in the actions of a yajña.
- **Question:** Who is the presiding authority (*sthitishīla*)?
  Answer: The Brahmin; the Brahmin is also the **ṛtvij** (Vedic officiant).
- **Question:** What are the *purities related to knowledge* (*jñānasambandha śuddhulu*)?
  Answer: They are all aspects of the yajña, including Vedic mantras and Kalpa sūtras. The Vedic mantras are arranged in seed-like forms (bīja) with minimal V**ē**dāksharās, presented in the form of sūtras.

Conclusion of Method-5:
The Kalpa texts are primarily composed in the form of sūtras with minimal V**ē**dāksharās. Their extensive and elaborate meanings, expressed through technical terminology, are constructed using short, concise sentences. This principle is demonstrated with the aid of RigVēda (8-38-1).

Method-6:
RigVēda (10-190-3)

- **देवता:** भाववृत्तम्
- **ऋषि:** अघमर्षणो माधुच्छन्दसः

- **छन्द:** पादनिचृत्त्रिष्टुप्
- **स्वर:** गान्धारः

सूर्याचन्द्रमसौ धाता यथापूर्वमकल्पयत् । दिवं च पृथिवीं चान्तरिक्षमथो स्वः ॥

Essence of RigVēda (10-190-3):
Brahman, at the beginning of every creation, like the primordial Kalpa, upholds the Sun, the Moon, the sky, the Earth, and the firmament, along with the stars.

Proposition:
- **Question:** What existed at the beginning of Brahmā's day of creation?
  Answer: Brahmā upheld the Sun, the Moon, the sky, the Earth, and the firmament along with the stars**.**
- **Question:** Who sustains this creation?
  Answer: Brahmā.
- **Question:** According to the primordial order, what did Brahmā create?
  Answer: The Sun and Moon, the sky, the Earth, and the firmament.
- **Question:** How did creation proceed according to the primordial order?
  Answer: Brahmā created in accordance with the prior order to ensure the continuation of creation**.**

Conclusion of Method-6:
The term Kalpa is a frequently occurring Vedic word**.** This principle has been investigated and demonstrated with the aid of RigVēda (10-190-3).

Method-7:
RigVēda (10-1-5)
- **देवता:** अग्निः
- **ऋषि:** त्रितः
- **छन्द:** निचृत्त्रिष्टुप्
- **स्वर:** धैवतः

होतारं चित्ररथमध्वरस्य यज्ञस्ययज्ञस्य केतुं रुशन्तम् । प्रत्यर्धिं देवस्यदेवस्य मह्ना श्रिया त्व१ग्निमतिथिं जनानाम् ॥

Essence of RigVēda (10-1-5):
The yajña is the act or endeavor performed by human beings for their own advancement, an Agni-related ritual or effort through which they ascend from their physical, mental, and spiritual state to a higher state of excellence**.**

Proposition:
- **Question:** What is a *yajña*?
  Answer: It is the means by which every action attains its fulfillment**.**
- **Question:** Who are the ones that invite the dēvat*ās*?
  Answer: The Hotṛ (priest) invites the dēvat*ās* through his sacred utterances (vocal invocations)**.**
- **Question:** Who is known by his variegated radiance?
  Answer: Agni**,** who is recognized by his sevenfold brilliance (the seven colors of light)**.**
- **Question:** Who conveys the oblations to the dēvat*ās*?
  Answer: Agni conveys the **हविस्** to the dēvat*ās*.
- **Question:** What is the benefit obtained from this *yajña*?
  Answer: The three worlds - Earth (Pṛthivī), Atmosphere (Antarikṣa), and Heaven (Dyuloka**)** become energized and strengthened, and thus human beings attain growth and prosperity.

Conclusion of Method-7:
This mantra (RigVēda (10-1-5)) declares that the yajña elevates one from the existing state to a higher state of excellence**.**

Method-8:
RigVēda (10-15-11)
देवता: पितरः
ऋषि: शङ्खो यामायनः
छन्द: निचृज्जगती
स्वर: निषादः
अग्निष्वात्ताः पितर एह गच्छत सदःसदः सदत सुप्रणीतयः । अत्ता हवींषि प्रयतानि बर्हिष्यथा रयिं सर्ववीरं दधातन ॥

Essence of RigVēda (10-15-11):
The **Pitṛ** dēvat*ās*, known as the **Agniṣvāttas** who depend upon the yajña, come here from all directions and proceed to the **assemblies of the most exalted sages**, who expound the **noblest means for both worldly and transcendental (otherworldly) well-being**. Having partaken of the **auspicious food offerings placed upon the sacred darbha grass**, may the **Pitṛs** bestow upon their **sons and grandsons** the **highest states of prosperity and blessed existence**, thus do human beings pray.

Proposition:
- **Question:** How are the Agniṣvātta Pitṛ dēvat*ās* invited?
  Answer: They are invited **through the performance of the yajña**.
- **Question:** Who proceeds to the assemblies where the means for worldly and transcendental well-being are discussed?
  Answer: The **Pitṛs, known as the Agniṣvāttas**.
- **Question:** Who bestows the highest states of prosperity and blessedness?
  Answer: The **Pitṛs, the Agniṣvāttas**.
- **Question:** In what are the food offerings for the Pitṛs placed and experienced?
  Answer: In the **sacred darbha grass**.
- **Question:** When human beings offer their invocation, who comes in response?
  Answer: The **Agniṣvātta Pitṛ** dēvat*ās*.
- **Question:** With what should the proper condition for righteous human conduct be kindled?
  Answer: It should be kindled with the **fire of knowledge (jñānāgni)**.
- **Question:** Who goes to the assemblies of the most exalted sages?
  Answer: The **Pitṛ** dēvat*ās***, the Agniṣvāttas**.
- **Question:** Do the Pitṛ dēvat*ās*, when invoked with Vēdic mantras, truly come?
  Answer: Yes, they certainly come **to receive the oblations offered through the yajña**.
- **Question:** Where should the firm resolve of beings in the inner worlds be directed?
  Answer: They should be directed **to the divine realms (dēvaloka) through the yajña**.

Conclusion of Method-8:
Wherever thoughts arise, wherever knowledge conducive to the right conduct of living beings abides, and wherever the primordial wisdom - the very source that gives rise to human birth resides, **there the fire (Agni) must be kindled.** The firm and determined intentions present within the inner cosmos should be directed **toward that very locus.** This principle has been demonstrated with the support of RigVēda (10-15-11) as the basis for this inquiry.

Method-9:
RigVēda (6-69-1)
- **देवता:** इन्द्राविष्णू
- **ऋषि:** भरद्वाजो बार्हस्पत्यः

- **छन्द:** निचृत्त्रिष्टुप्
- **स्वर:** धैवतः

सं वां॒ कर्म॑णा॒ समि॒षा हि॑नो॒मीन्द्रा॑विष्णू॒ अप॑सस्पा॒रे अ॒स्य। जु॒षेथां॑ य॒ज्ञं द्रवि॑णं च धत्त॒मरि॑ष्टैर्नः प॒थिभिः॑ पा॒रय॑न्ता ॥१॥

Essence of RigVēda (6-69-1):
Through the combined actions of Indra and Viṣṇu, I attain abundant growth and expansion.
With pure intention and through the non-violent paths of sacred action (*karma*), may you both lead us safely across to the two shores, that is, from the mortal to the divine realm.
May you both take delight in this *yajña* and bestow upon us the sustaining wealth that upholds both material and spiritual prosperity.

Proposition:
- **Question:** Through whose actions does one attain abundant growth and expansion?
  Answer: Through the combined actions of Indra and Viṣṇu.
- **Question:** By what means is this growth or attainment realized?
  Answer: Through pure intention and non-violent paths of sacred action (*karma*).
- **Question:** What is meant by “the two shores”?
  Answer: The two shores symbolize the realms of the mortal and the divine.
- **Question:** What do Indra and Viṣṇu do in relation to the *yajña*?
  Answer: They take delight in the *yajña* and bless it with their divine presence.
- **Question:** What do they bestow upon the performer of the *yajña*?
  Answer: They grant the sustaining wealth that upholds both material and spiritual prosperity.

Conclusion of Method-9:
The Vēda designates that divine state as *“Saṃjñānam”* (Perfect Awareness or Conscious Integration). The Vēda names that endeavor *“Yajña”* (the sacred act of self-offering or spiritual communion). The Vēda also refers to this effort as *“Deva-Karma”* - the divine action or work of the gods.

Method-10:
Yajur Vēda (34-1)
- **देवता:** मनो देवता
- **ऋषि:** शिवसङ्कल्प ऋषिः
- **छन्द:** विराट्त्रिष्टुप्
- **स्वर:** धैवतः

यज्जाग्र॑तो दू॒रमु॒दैति॒ दैवं॒ तदु॑ सु॒प्तस्य॒ तथै॒वैति॑। दू॒रङ्ग॒मं ज्योति॑षां॒ ज्योति॒रेकं॒ तन्मे॒ मनः॑ शि॒वस॑ङ्कल्पमस्तु ॥१ ॥

Essence of Yajur Vēda (34-1):
O Lord! For what reason does my mind, in its waking state, wander afar, carried away by divine contemplations? Indeed, that very mind either attains the deep sleep of *suṣupti* or travels to great distances in the realm of dreams. May that Light - the Radiance of all radiances, illumine my mind so that it may engage only in auspicious and benevolent activities of thought.

Proposition
- **Question:** Where do thoughts arise?
  Answer: Thoughts and imaginations arise within the mind.
- **Question:** What happens to the thoughts that arise continually?
  Answer: They dissolve into the *chitta* (the deeper consciousness).
- **Question:** What is the waking state (*jāgrat-avasthā*)?
  Answer: It is the state in which one perceives and understands material objects while awake.

- **Question:** What is the state of deep sleep (*suṣupti*)?
  Answer: It is the condition of complete unawareness - the state of deep slumber.
- **Question:** What is the dream state (*svapna-avasthā*)?
  Answer: It is the state in which one experiences dreams during sleep.

Conclusion of Method-10:
This activity perpetually takes place within both the subtle (*sūkṣma*) and the cosmic (*brahmāṇḍa*) spheres; therefore, it too is a form of *Yajña* (sacrificial process).
Through this mantra, it is demonstrated that returning to the source from which all things have originated is the inherent principle of creation (*sṛṣṭi-lakṣaṇa*).

Conclusion:
The study demonstrates that the *Vēdas* encompass and transcend the six *śāstras*, establishing themselves as the supreme repository of knowledge. They manifest the principle of *Śabda-Brahman*, the Divine Word or Sound Absolute, through which both the external universe and the inner realms of individual consciousness are nurtured and elevated. Human comprehension, grounded in the five elements, arises through worldly cognition (*lokajñāna*), yet the *Vēdāksharās*, words, and mantras are naturally designed to inspire deeper understanding and spiritual significance.
The functional presentation of mantras, as elucidated in the *Kalpa-śāstra*, ensures that their meaning is intelligible and actionable, guiding practitioners toward the transformative power of *yajña*. This sacred act, whether performed in the subtle or cosmic spheres, aligns human effort with the divine order and fosters the attainment of higher consciousness (*Saṃjñānam*). Through the recurring symbolism of Agni, the Vēda illustrates that thought, knowledge, and primordial wisdom must converge in the conscious act of offering, reflecting the intrinsic principle of creation (*sṛṣṭi-lakṣaṇa*).
Ultimately, the *Vēda* affirms that every ritual, mantra, and meditative act constitutes a *Deva-Karma*, a divine engagement through which beings return to their source, achieve excellence, and realize the unity of sound, consciousness, and action.

References:

1. RigVēda (1-10-4)
2. RigVēda (1-102-8)
3. RigVēda (1-142-9) and RigVēda (10-110-8)
4. RigVēda (8-30-2)
5. RigVēda (8-38-1)
6. RigVēda (10-190-3)
7. RigVēda (10-1-5)
8. RigVēda (10-15-11)
9. RigVēda (6-69-1)
10. Yajur Vēda (34-1)